

Daily Bible Note

Date: June 20, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Jonah 1:1-10

1 Now the word of the Lord came to Jonah the son of Amittai, saying,

2 "Arise, go to Nineveh, that great city, and cry out against it; for their wickedness has come up before Me."

3 But Jonah arose to flee to Tarshish from the presence of the Lord. He went down to Joppa, and found a ship going to Tarshish; so he paid the fare, and went down into it, to go with them to Tarshish from the presence of the Lord.

4 But the Lord sent out a great wind on the sea, and there was a mighty tempest on the sea, so that the ship was about to be broken up.

5 Then the mariners were afraid; and every man cried out to his god, and threw the cargo that was in the ship into the sea, to lighten the load. But Jonah had gone down into the lowest parts of the ship, had lain down, and was fast asleep.

6 So the captain came to him, and said to him, "What do you mean, sleeper? Arise, call on your God; perhaps your God will consider us, so that we may not perish."

7 And they said to one another, "Come, let us cast lots, that we may know for whose cause this trouble has come upon us." So they cast lots, and the lot fell on Jonah.

8 Then they said to him, "Please tell us! For whose cause is this trouble upon us? What is your occupation? And where do you come from? What is your country? And of what people are you?"

9 So he said to them, "I am a Hebrew; and I fear the Lord, the God of heaven, who made the sea and the dry land."

10 Then the men were exceedingly afraid, and said to him, "Why have you done this?" For the men knew that he fled from the presence of the Lord, because he had told them.

II. Key Summary

- God called Jonah to go east to the foreign city of Nineveh and preach against its wickedness, but Jonah boarded a ship heading in the opposite direction toward Tarshish (vv. 1-3)
 - The Lord sent a great storm that threatened to break the ship apart; the pagan sailors each cried out to their gods and threw cargo overboard to lighten the load, while Jonah lay fast asleep in the lowest part of the ship (vv. 4-6)
 - Casting lots identified Jonah as the cause of the trouble; Jonah confessed he was a Hebrew fleeing from the Lord, the God who made the sea and dry land (vv. 7-10)
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III. Passage Analysis

Running from God Only Takes You the Long Way Around

"No escape is possible from the divine will. The sailors — pagan outsiders — recognize God's power before the prophet does, highlighting a crucial paradox: the one who knows God best is the one running hardest in the other direction." [1]

Jonah paid the fare, stepped on board, and probably felt like he'd solved the problem — until the storm hit. This passage makes the point clearly: running away doesn't make the situation disappear, it just means the road back is longer and the cost is higher than it would have been to simply obey.

Knowing God, But Asleep When It Matters

"What a curious and tragic scene! All the sailors were religious men, devout in their prayers to their gods... There was one man on board who had a relationship with the true God, who knew His word, and who worshiped Him — yet he was asleep!" [2]

Jonah knew exactly who God was — verse 9 makes that unmistakably clear. But in the moment that demanded action, he was gone. The pagan sailors were praying harder than the prophet of God. This contrast is a sharp reminder that knowing about God and actually responding to Him in real life are two very different things.

IV. Reflection Question

Is there something you know you should do — a responsibility, a conversation, a step of faith — but you've been putting it off or finding ways to go around it?

Jonah knew God made the sea, and still got on the boat going the other way. What we know about God is real — but how we respond to it is where faith actually shows up.

References

[1] BibleProject, Book of Jonah Guide, <https://bibleproject.com/guides/book-of-jonah/>

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/jonah-1/>